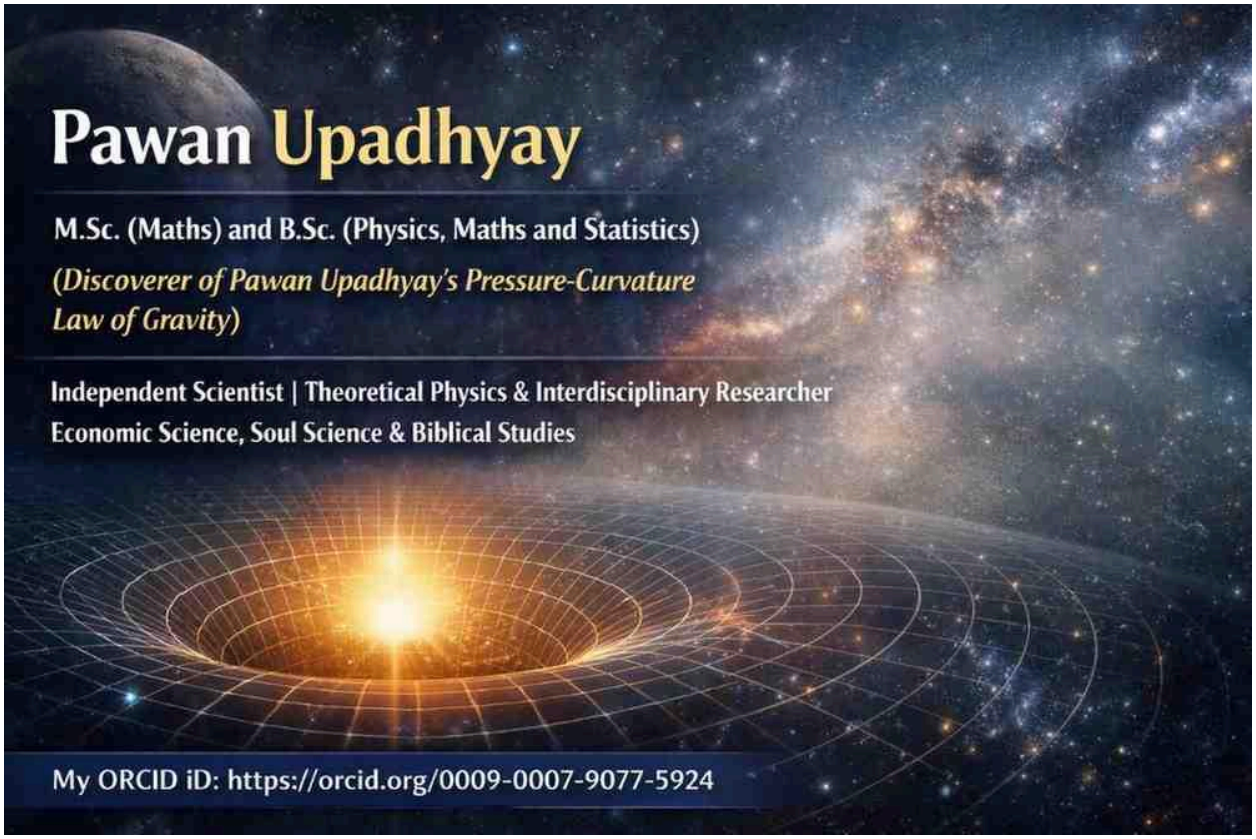
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The Living Divine Word and the Victory Over Death

Gospel of Thomas — Saying 1

A Theological Research Paper on the Interpretation of the Living Divine Word, Holy Life, Divine Grace, Resurrection, and Victory Over Death

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Abstract

The first saying of the *Gospel of Thomas* presents a short but profound statement attributed to Jesus:

“Whoever finds the interpretation of these words will not taste death.”

The saying places particular emphasis upon the **interpretation** or **meaning** of the words of Jesus. This research paper develops a theological interpretation of this saying through the concept of Jesus Christ as the **Living Divine Word**.

The central argument of this paper is that the words of Christ should not be understood merely as historical sayings or moral instructions. Within a Christian theological framework, Jesus Christ Himself is the Living Word of God. The Gospel of John explicitly identifies the Word with God and declares that the Word became flesh in Jesus Christ. It also associates Christ with life, light, resurrection, and eternal life.

Accordingly, the “interpretation” of the words in Thomas 1 may be contemplated as a spiritual understanding that moves beyond intellectual knowledge toward **faithful implementation in life**. The holy words of Christ teach repentance, prayer, forgiveness, love, mercy, charity, holiness, righteousness, and devotion to God. Their implementation leads the believer toward Divine Grace and toward a life guided by the Holy Spirit.

This paper further examines the relationship between the Living Word, Christ's miracles, healing, deliverance from evil, resurrection, divine judgment, hell, and eternal life. It proposes that the phrase “will not taste death” can be interpreted within Christian theology as pointing toward the victory of divine life over death.

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1. Introduction

The *Gospel of Thomas* contains 114 sayings attributed to Jesus. Unlike the canonical Gospels, it is primarily organized as a collection of sayings rather than as a continuous narrative of Jesus' ministry, death, and resurrection.

Its first saying is therefore particularly significant:

“Whoever finds the interpretation of these words will not taste death.”

The saying immediately establishes the importance of **understanding**.

Jesus' words are presented as something that must be interpreted, discovered, and understood. The saying therefore raises an important theological question:

What does it mean to find the interpretation of the words of the Living Christ?

This paper approaches that question through the theological concept of Jesus Christ as the **Living Divine Word**.

The interpretation proposed here is not that Thomas 1 itself explicitly contains the complete doctrine of the Incarnation, the Trinity, hell, the Holy Spirit, or Christian salvation. Rather, the argument is that Thomas 1 can be placed into a broader Christian theological conversation with the canonical Scriptures, especially the Gospel of John.

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2. Jesus Christ as the Living Divine Word

The foundation of this theological interpretation is found particularly in the opening of the Gospel of John:

“In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.”

John subsequently states:

“And the Word became flesh and dwelt among us.”

Within Christian theology, these passages provide the foundation for identifying Jesus Christ with the **Divine Word**.

The Word is not presented merely as information or speech. The Johannine prologue associates the Word with creation, life, and light:

“In him was life, and that life was the light of all mankind.”

This provides an important theological connection to Thomas 1.

If Christ is the Living Divine Word, then the words spoken by Christ are not merely ordinary human instructions. They are words that reveal the divine will and call humanity toward life.

Therefore:

The Living Word speaks holy words, and the holy words reveal the path of divine life.

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3. The Meaning of “Finding the Interpretation”

The key phrase in Saying 1 is the finding of the **interpretation** or **meaning** of Jesus' words. Different translations render the saying somewhat differently, including “finds the meaning of these sayings” and “penetrates the meaning of these words.” The surviving textual tradition therefore emphasizes discovery of meaning rather than mere repetition of words.

This distinction is fundamental.

A person can hear the words of Jesus without understanding them.

A person can read the words of Jesus without practicing them.

A person can memorize Scripture without allowing Scripture to transform the heart.

Therefore, in this theological interpretation, finding the interpretation means seeking the deeper spiritual meaning of the words and allowing that meaning to become a way of life.

The process may be represented as:

Hearing → Understanding → Believing → Practicing → Transformation → Holiness → Life

The interpretation of Christ's words is consequently not merely an intellectual exercise.5

It becomes a spiritual discipline.

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4. The Holy Words of the Living Divine Word

The teachings of Jesus address the fundamental dimensions of human life.

Christ taught about:

- repentance,
- prayer,
- forgiveness,
- love,
- mercy,

- peace,
- charity,
- humility,
- righteousness,
- holiness,
- faith,
- the Kingdom of God,
- eternal life.

The words of Christ therefore provide instruction concerning both the relationship between humanity and God and the relationship between human beings.

The holy words call the person away from hatred, cruelty, sin, pride, and evil and toward love, mercy, forgiveness, holiness, and righteousness.

Consequently, the interpretation of the words cannot be separated from their implementation.

To understand the holy words is to seek to live the holy words.

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5. The Living Word and the Miracles of Christ

The ministry of Jesus is presented in the canonical Gospels as a ministry in which His teaching is accompanied by powerful works.

Jesus heals the sick.

Jesus raises the dead.

Jesus casts out demons.

Jesus exercises authority over natural forces.

Jesus forgives sins.

Jesus restores people who have been separated from their communities.

These actions demonstrate that the ministry of Jesus involves both **word and deed**.

His words and actions belong together.

The Living Word does not merely speak about life.

The Living Word gives life.

The Gospel of John connects Jesus directly with resurrection and life:

“I am the resurrection and the life.”

This statement provides a particularly important theological parallel to Thomas 1.

Thomas speaks of not tasting death.

John presents Jesus Himself as **the Resurrection and the Life**.

Together, these texts invite reflection upon the relationship between Christ's words and the divine life He embodies.

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6. Christ as Holy Medicine

Jesus' healing ministry can be contemplated as an expression of divine mercy.

The sick approached Him seeking restoration.

The possessed were delivered.

The suffering received compassion.

The dead were restored to life in particular Gospel narratives.

Therefore, Christ can be understood metaphorically as the **Holy Medicine** for humanity—not merely medicine for physical illness, but medicine for the deeper wounds of sin, spiritual darkness, alienation, and death.

This metaphor should not be understood as a claim that Christian faith replaces medical treatment. Rather, it expresses the theological conviction that Christ brings healing at the deepest spiritual level.

The Living Word therefore becomes:

Healing for the wounded soul,
light for the darkness,
truth for confusion,
forgiveness for the repentant,
and life in the presence of death.

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7. The Living Word and Resurrection

The concept of resurrection is central to Christian faith.

In John 11, Jesus tells Martha:

“I am the resurrection and the life.”

The statement does not merely say that Jesus teaches about resurrection.

It identifies Jesus Himself with **resurrection and life**.

This provides an important theological framework for understanding Thomas 1.

The person who discovers the meaning of Christ's words encounters teachings that point toward life rather than death.

The Living Word therefore teaches the way of life while Himself being identified with life.

The theological movement can be expressed as:

Living Word → Holy Words → Understanding → Faith → Holy Life → Resurrection → Eternal Life

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8. Implementation of the Holy Words in Human Life

A central principle of this research is that understanding the words of Christ should produce action.

The holy words are not intended merely to remain in books.

They are intended to become visible in human life.

The person who seeks to implement Christ's teachings practices:

Love instead of hatred.

Forgiveness instead of revenge.

Mercy instead of cruelty.

Charity instead of selfishness.

Peace instead of hostility.

Humility instead of pride.

Repentance instead of persistent sin.

Prayer instead of spiritual neglect.

Holiness instead of corruption.

In this sense, the implementation of Christ's words becomes a form of spiritual discipline.

The Living Word is heard through the ears, understood through the mind, received through the heart, and manifested through one's actions.

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9. Divine Grace and the Guidance of the Holy Spirit

The implementation of Christ's holy words can also be understood as a movement toward **Divine Grace**.

Christian theology traditionally understands grace as God's gracious action toward humanity.

John's Gospel describes Jesus Christ in connection with grace and truth:

“Grace and truth came through Jesus Christ.”

The believer therefore does not pursue holiness solely through human strength.

The Christian life is understood as dependent upon God's grace and guidance.

Within this theological framework, the Holy Spirit guides the believer toward truth, holiness, repentance, love, and obedience to God.

Thus:

Holy Word → Faithful Implementation → Divine Grace → Guidance of the Holy Spirit → Spiritual Transformation

The person seeks to cooperate with God's grace by allowing the teachings of Christ to shape thought, speech, conduct, relationships, and spiritual discipline.

---

10. Repentance, Confession, and Holy Prayer

The interpretation of Christ's words includes a call to repentance.

Repentance means turning away from sin and turning toward God.

Confession acknowledges wrongdoing before God.

Prayer establishes communion with God.

These practices are therefore essential components of the holy life.

The Living Word teaches humanity not merely to recognize evil but to turn away from it.

Repentance consequently becomes a movement from:

Sin → Recognition → Confession → Repentance → Forgiveness → Transformation

The person who seeks the meaning of Christ's words must therefore consider how those words apply personally.

The question becomes not simply:

“What did Jesus teach?”

but also:

“How must I live because Jesus taught this?”

---

11. The Kingdom of God and Eternal Life

The teachings of Jesus repeatedly direct attention toward the Kingdom of God.

The Kingdom represents God's rule and God's purposes.

The person who follows the Living Word is therefore called to orient life toward God's Kingdom rather than toward the temporary attractions of worldly existence.

The Christian hope ultimately extends beyond earthly life.

John 3:16 connects faith in Christ with eternal life, while John 11:25–26 directly connects Jesus with resurrection and life.

Therefore, “not tasting death” may be contemplated within this broader Christian framework as a promise concerning participation in divine life.

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12. Hell and Divine Judgment

Christian Scripture also teaches divine judgment.

A separate theological dimension of this research concerns hell as a place associated with God's judgment upon evil.

Matthew 25:41 describes eternal fire as having been prepared for “the devil and his angels.”

Within traditional Christian theology, hell is consequently associated with the judgment of Satan and the powers of evil, as well as with the judgment of human beings who persist in rebellion against God.

The punishment of hell is presented in Scripture through severe imagery.

This gives seriousness to the call of Christ toward repentance and holiness.

However, Christian traditions differ regarding the precise nature and duration of hell. Therefore, the present paper treats the doctrine of hell as a theological component of the Christian framework rather than claiming that Thomas 1 itself explains the doctrine of hell.

The relationship can nevertheless be understood conceptually:

God's holy life → invitation to repentance and holiness

Persistent evil → divine judgment

The warning of judgment and the promise of life therefore stand together.

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13. The Soul and Death

The statement that the soul is immortal represents a particular theological position and should be distinguished from what Thomas 1 explicitly states.

Christian traditions have developed different understandings of the soul, resurrection, immortality, judgment, and eternal punishment.

Within the theological perspective developed in this paper, however, the soul is understood as created for relationship with God.

The deepest form of death is therefore understood spiritually as separation from the source of divine life.

This gives particular significance to Jesus' statement:

“I am the resurrection and the life.”

The hope of the believer is not simply the indefinite continuation of earthly existence.

It is participation in the life of God.

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14. Victory Over Satan, Evil, and Death

The ministry of Jesus is presented as a confrontation with evil.

Jesus resisted temptation.

Jesus confronted demonic powers.

Jesus called sinners to repentance.

Jesus taught forgiveness and love.

Jesus died and, according to Christian faith, rose again.

Consequently, the Christian proclamation understands Christ's work as a victory over the powers of sin and death.

This is central to the meaning of “victory over death.”

Death does not possess ultimate authority over the Living Word.

The resurrection becomes the decisive expression of this Christian hope.

The darkness does not overcome the light.

The Living Word remains the source of life.

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15. Gospel of Thomas Saying 1 and Johannine Theology

A comparison with John's Gospel is especially illuminating.

Theme	Gospel of Thomas, Saying 1	Gospel of John
Words of Jesus	Their interpretation must be discovered	Jesus' words reveal divine truth and life
Death	Whoever finds their meaning will not taste death	Believers receive life through Christ
Word	Thomas 1 emphasizes interpretation of Jesus' sayings	John explicitly identifies Christ with the Divine Word
Life	Understanding the words is associated with escaping death	Christ is the Resurrection and the Life
Divine revelation	Meaning must be discovered	The Word becomes flesh and reveals God
Transformation	Implied through understanding	Explicitly connected with faith and life

The texts are not identical in theology or literary form. Nevertheless, the comparison reveals a strong conceptual field around **Jesus, words, life, and death**. Thomas 1 can therefore be fruitfully interpreted alongside Johannine theology, provided that the two texts are not treated as though they were written as a single document.

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16. The Meaning of “Not Taste Death”

The expression “not taste death” is the theological climax of Saying 1.

There are several possible ways of understanding it.

First, it can refer to **spiritual life**.

Second, it can refer to **eschatological life**—life beyond death.

Third, within Christian theological interpretation, it can be connected to the promise of resurrection.

John 11:25–26 provides an especially close conceptual parallel because Jesus declares that the believer will live even though physical death occurs and speaks of never dying in the context of belief in Him.

Thus, the statement need not be interpreted as claiming that faithful human beings will never physically die.

Rather, theologically, it can be understood as asserting that physical death does not have the final authority over the person who participates in the life of Christ.

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17. Knowledge, Interpretation, and Transformation

The word **knowledge** must be treated carefully.

Knowing the words of Jesus intellectually is not necessarily equivalent to living according to them.

The *Gospel of Thomas* itself repeatedly emphasizes seeking and discovering. For example, Saying 2 begins with seeking and finding.

Therefore, the “knowledge” contemplated in this paper is not merely accumulation of information.

It is **transformative understanding**.

A person understands forgiveness by forgiving.

A person understands mercy by practicing mercy.

A person understands charity by giving.

A person understands repentance by turning away from evil.

A person understands holiness by pursuing holiness.

A person understands the love of Christ by allowing that love to transform relationships.

Therefore:

True interpretation produces transformation.

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18. The Living Divine Word as a Way of Life

The central proposition of this research can be summarized as follows:

Jesus Christ is the Living Divine Word.

His holy words reveal God's will.

His holy actions demonstrate divine life, mercy, healing, and authority.

His teachings call humanity toward repentance and holiness.

His words teach love, forgiveness, peace, mercy, prayer, charity, and righteousness.

Their faithful implementation becomes a path of spiritual transformation.

Divine Grace enables the believer to continue upon that path.

The Holy Spirit provides divine guidance.

Christ is the Resurrection and the Life.

Therefore, the Living Word leads humanity toward victory over spiritual death and toward eternal life.

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19. A Proposed Spiritual Model

The theological framework developed here can be represented as a sequence:

1. The Living Divine Word

Jesus Christ

↓

2. Holy Words

The teachings and commands of Christ

↓

3. Interpretation

Discovering the spiritual meaning of those words

↓

4. Faith

Trusting Christ and receiving His teaching

↓

5. Implementation

Living according to His teachings

↓

6. Repentance and Holiness

Turning away from sin and pursuing righteousness

↓

7. Divine Grace

Receiving God's gracious help

↓

8. Guidance of the Holy Spirit

Growing in truth, holiness, wisdom, and spiritual discipline

↓

9. Resurrection and Life

Participation in the life promised through Christ

↓

10. Victory Over Death

The ultimate Christian hope of eternal life

This model represents the author's theological interpretation rather than a claim that Thomas 1 itself explicitly lays out all ten stages.

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20. Conclusion

The first saying of the *Gospel of Thomas* is remarkably concise:

“Whoever finds the interpretation of these words will not taste death.”

Yet the statement opens a profound theological question concerning the relationship between the words of Jesus and eternal life.

Through the Christian doctrine of Jesus Christ as the **Living Divine Word**, the saying can be contemplated as an invitation to discover the divine meaning of Christ's teachings.

The Living Word is not merely a speaker of religious instructions.

Christ is presented in Johannine theology as the Word through whom life and light are revealed, and Jesus declares Himself to be the Resurrection and the Life.

Therefore, the interpretation of His words should become a living spiritual practice.

The holy words of Christ call humanity toward:

repentance,
confession,
prayer,

faith,
holiness,
righteousness,
love,
forgiveness,
mercy,
peace,
charity,
and the Kingdom of God.

When these teachings are implemented in life, the believer seeks to walk within Divine Grace and under the guidance of the Holy Spirit.

The doctrine of divine judgment provides the corresponding warning: evil and persistent rebellion against God have consequences, while the Gospel presents Christ as the source of reconciliation and life.

The central theological insight of this paper can therefore be stated:

The Living Divine Word, Jesus Christ, speaks holy words that reveal the way of divine life. To find their interpretation is not merely to understand their vocabulary; it is to discover their spiritual meaning and allow that meaning to transform one's life. Through faith, repentance, holiness, Divine Grace, and the guidance of the Holy Spirit, the believer seeks the life promised by Christ and hopes for victory over death.

Thus, the words of the Living Divine Word become not merely words written in a book.

They become a path of life.

References and Primary Texts

1. *Gospel of Thomas*, Saying 1. The saying is preserved in Coptic at Nag Hammadi and in Greek fragments from Oxyrhynchus; translations differ slightly in wording but retain the central idea of finding the interpretation or meaning of Jesus' words and not tasting/experiencing death.
2. *Gospel according to John*, 1:1–18. The Johannine prologue identifies the Word with God and states that the Word became flesh.
3. *Gospel according to John*, 11:25–26. Jesus identifies Himself as “the resurrection and the life” and connects belief in Him with life beyond death.
4. *Gospel according to John*, 14:6. Jesus identifies Himself with “the way,” “the truth,” and “the life.”

5. *Gospel according to Matthew*, 25:41. The passage associates eternal fire with divine judgment and describes it as prepared for the devil and his angels.

Author's Theological Statement

[Pawan Upadhyay Bible]

This research is a theological exploration of the Living Divine Word, Jesus Christ, and the meaning of His holy words. It seeks to understand the first saying of the *Gospel of Thomas* through a Christian theological framework centered upon Christ as the Living Word, the Resurrection, and the source of eternal life.

The central conviction is:

“Whoever finds the interpretation of the words of the Living Divine Word will not taste death.”

The interpretation is therefore a call not merely to read the holy words of Jesus Christ, but to **understand them, receive them, implement them, and allow them to transform the life of the believer toward holiness, Divine Grace, and eternal life.**

✝️Expanded Research Paper🪯

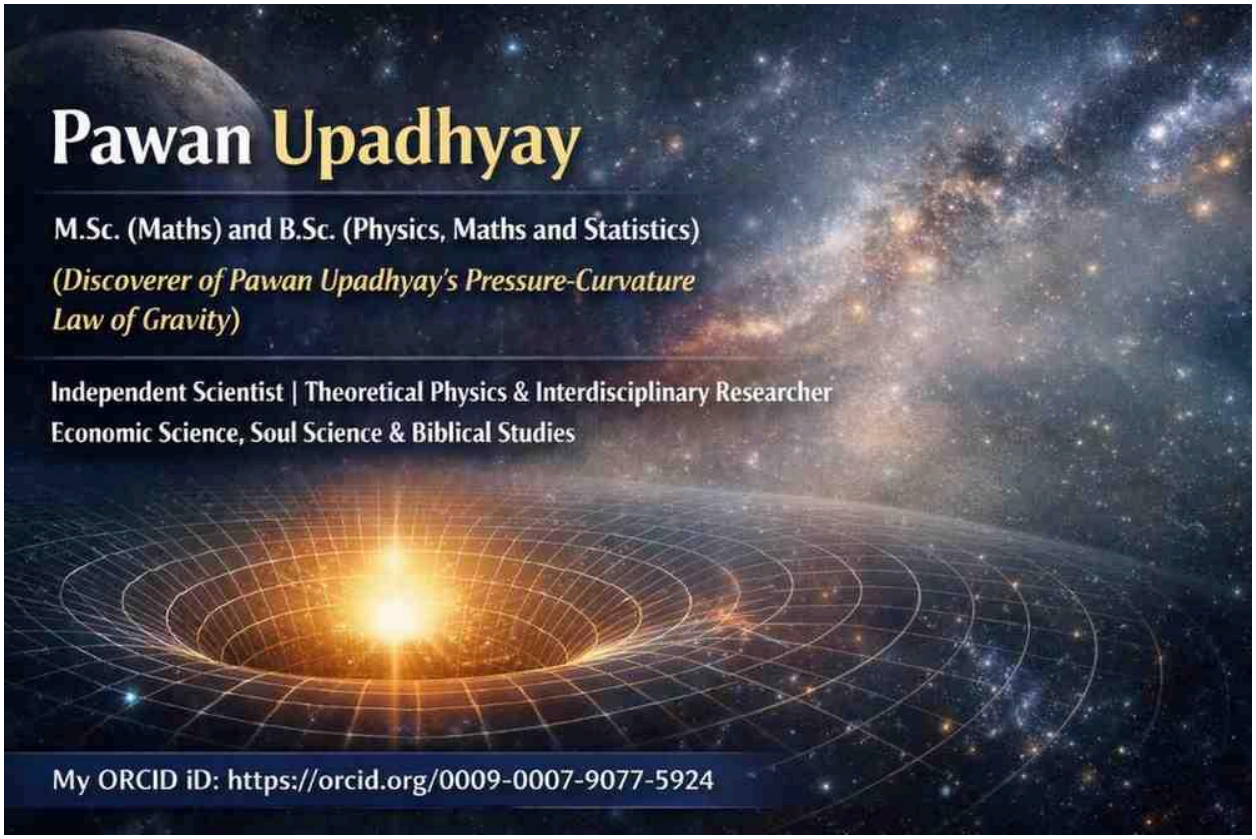
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THE LIVING DIVINE WORD AND THE VICTORY OVER DEATH

Gospel of Thomas — Saying 1

An Extended Theological Research Paper on the Interpretation of the Living Divine Word, Holy Words, Holy Actions, Divine Grace, the Holy Spirit, Resurrection, Judgment, and Eternal Life

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Abstract

The first saying of the *Gospel of Thomas* presents a remarkably concise statement:

“Whoever finds the interpretation of these sayings will not taste death.”

The saying places interpretation, understanding, and the overcoming of death into a single theological relationship. The *Gospel of Thomas* begins its collection of sayings by directing the reader toward the discovery of their meaning. This creates an important interpretive question:

What does it mean to discover the meaning of the words of Jesus, and why is this discovery associated with victory over death?

This paper develops a Christian theological interpretation of Saying 1 through the concept of Jesus Christ as the **Living Divine Word**. The central proposal is that the words of Jesus cannot be separated from the person of Jesus. In Johannine Christianity, Christ is identified with the Word: “In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God,” and “the Word became flesh.” The Word is also associated with life and light. Thus, a theological reading of Thomas 1 may understand the sayings of Jesus as words that communicate and reveal divine life.

The paper further develops a distinction between **hearing the holy words**, **understanding their interpretation**, and **implementing their meaning in life**. According to this framework, genuine interpretation is not merely intellectual knowledge. It becomes spiritual transformation. The holy words of Christ teach repentance, confession, prayer, holiness, righteousness, forgiveness, mercy, love, peace, charity, humility, and devotion to God. Their implementation directs the believer toward Divine Grace and dependence upon the guidance of the Holy Spirit.

The paper also examines Christ's holy actions: healing the sick, raising the dead, calming the storm, casting out demons and evil spirits, forgiving sins, and proclaiming the Kingdom of God. These actions are interpreted as manifestations of the Living Word. Christ is therefore contemplated not merely as a teacher who speaks about life but as the One who embodies divine life and declares Himself to be “the resurrection and the life.”

The study additionally considers the relationship between the Living Word and sin, Satan, evil, hell, divine judgment, death, resurrection, and eternal life. Matthew 25:41 is examined in relation to the biblical teaching concerning eternal fire prepared for the devil and his angels. The paper distinguishes these canonical teachings from Thomas 1 itself, since Thomas 1 does not explicitly present a complete doctrine of hell or the Holy Spirit.

The paper ultimately proposes a theological model:

Living Divine Word → Holy Words → Interpretation → Faith → Implementation → Repentance and Holiness → Divine Grace → Guidance of the Holy Spirit → Resurrection and Life → Victory Over Death.

The central conclusion is that, within this theological interpretation, to “find the interpretation” of the words of the Living Divine Word means to discover their divine meaning and allow that meaning to transform one's life. The promise of “not tasting death” is therefore contemplated as pointing beyond physical mortality toward participation in the divine life revealed and offered through Jesus Christ.

Keywords

Gospel of Thomas; Saying 1; Jesus Christ; Living Divine Word; Word of God; Holy Words; Divine Grace; Holy Spirit; Resurrection; Eternal Life; Death; Hell; Judgment; Satan; Repentance; Holiness; Kingdom of God; Christian Theology; Spiritual Transformation.

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1. Introduction

The *Gospel of Thomas* is an ancient collection of sayings attributed to Jesus. The surviving Coptic manuscript contains 114 sayings, while Greek fragments from Oxyrhynchus preserve portions of the text. Modern translations differ in wording, but Saying 1 consistently centers upon the discovery or interpretation of Jesus' words and the promise that the one who discovers their meaning “will not taste death.”

One translation renders the saying:

“Whoever finds the interpretation of these sayings will not taste death.”

Another gives:

“He who shall find the interpretation of the words shall not taste of death.”

The textual tradition therefore places two concepts together:

interpretation and **death**.

This connection is the starting point of the present research.

The question is not simply whether Jesus spoke words. The question is what happens when a person truly discovers the meaning of those words.

The theological perspective developed in this paper begins with the conviction that Jesus Christ is the **Living Divine Word**.

This conviction finds its clearest canonical expression in the Gospel of John:

“In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.”

John then declares:

“The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us.”

The Johannine prologue further associates the Word with life and light.

Consequently, a Christian theological reading can contemplate Jesus not simply as a teacher who possesses information about God, but as the **Living Word through whom divine life is revealed**.

This distinction becomes crucial.

If Jesus is the Living Divine Word, then understanding His words is not simply an exercise in historical interpretation. It becomes an encounter with a teaching that calls the human person toward God.

The present paper therefore investigates the following central proposition:

The interpretation of the words of the Living Divine Word is a spiritual discovery that must ultimately become a way of life.

The research develops this proposition through several interconnected themes:

1. Jesus Christ as the Living Divine Word.
2. The meaning of interpretation in Thomas 1.
3. Holy words and holy actions.
4. Christ's miracles and healing ministry.
5. Christ as spiritual medicine.
6. Repentance, confession, and prayer.
7. Implementation of Christ's teachings.
8. Divine Grace.
9. The guidance of the Holy Spirit.
10. The Kingdom of God.
11. Resurrection and eternal life.
12. Sin, Satan, evil, and judgment.
13. Hell and its punishment.
14. The soul and death.
15. Victory over death.
16. The relationship between Thomas 1 and Johannine theology.
17. The transformation of knowledge into holy life.

The goal is not to claim that all of these doctrines are explicitly contained within Thomas 1. Rather, the purpose is to develop a systematic Christian theological interpretation of the saying through dialogue with the canonical Scriptures and the theological ideas developed in this research.

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2. Research Question

The principal research question is:

What does the statement “Whoever finds the interpretation of these sayings will not taste death” mean when interpreted through the Christian understanding of Jesus Christ as the Living Divine Word?

Several subsidiary questions follow:

Question 1

What does “interpretation” mean in the context of Thomas 1?

Question 2

How can the words of Jesus be understood in relation to Jesus Himself as the Living Divine Word?

Question 3

How does understanding Christ's words relate to implementing them in daily life?

Question 4

How do repentance, holiness, prayer, love, forgiveness, mercy, and charity participate in this interpretation?

Question 5

What is the theological relationship between Divine Grace and the implementation of Christ's holy words?

Question 6

What role does the Holy Spirit play in guiding the believer?

Question 7

How does the Christian doctrine of resurrection illuminate the phrase “will not taste death”?

Question 8

How do divine judgment, hell, Satan, evil, and death function as contrasting realities to the life offered through Christ?

Question 9

How can Thomas 1 be compared with the Johannine concept of the Divine Word without confusing the two texts?

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3. Methodology

This research uses a **theological and comparative textual methodology**.

The primary text is *Gospel of Thomas*, Saying 1.

The principal canonical texts used for theological comparison include:

- John 1:1–18
- John 3:16
- John 5
- John 6
- John 8
- John 10
- John 11:25–26
- John 14:6
- Matthew 25:31–46
- Matthew 28
- Mark 4
- Mark 5
- Luke 8
- Luke 15
- Luke 18
- Luke 24
- Acts
- Romans
- 1 Corinthians 15
- Galatians
- Ephesians
- Revelation

The methodology makes three distinctions.

3.1 Historical-textual claim

A statement about what *Gospel of Thomas* Saying 1 actually says.

3.2 Canonical Christian claim

A statement concerning the teaching of the canonical New Testament.

3.3 Authorial theological interpretation

A theological synthesis developed by Pawan Upadhyay from Thomas 1, the canonical Scriptures, and the theological framework expressed in this research.

Maintaining these distinctions is important.

Thomas 1 does not itself explicitly say that Jesus is the Johannine Logos, nor does it explicitly describe hell, the Holy Spirit, or the complete Christian doctrine of resurrection. Those connections are developed through theological interpretation and comparison.

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4. The Text of Gospel of Thomas Saying 1

A commonly cited translation reads:

“Whoever discovers the interpretation of these sayings will not taste death.”

Another translation reads:

“He who shall find the interpretation of the words shall not taste of death.”

The surviving textual evidence includes both Coptic and Greek witnesses. The Greek fragment corresponding to the opening sayings confirms the basic structure of the statement.

The wording is important because the saying does not simply say:

“Whoever hears these words will not die.”

Nor does it simply say:

“Whoever believes these words will not die.”

Instead, it speaks of finding their **interpretation** or **meaning**.

This makes interpretation the key intellectual and spiritual activity.

The reader is invited to search beneath the surface.

The words contain meaning.

The meaning must be discovered.

The discovery is associated with life.

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5. Interpretation as Spiritual Discovery

The phrase “finds the interpretation” suggests that the sayings require active engagement.

The reader must seek.

The reader must contemplate.

The reader must understand.

The reader must distinguish the surface from the deeper meaning.

The opening of Thomas therefore presents the sayings as something that demands spiritual attention.

This is especially significant because Saying 2 immediately continues the theme of seeking and finding:

“Those who seek should not stop seeking until they find.”

Thus, the beginning of Thomas establishes a movement:

seek → find → understand → transform.

Within the present theological framework, this movement can be connected with the spiritual life.

A person may hear the command to forgive without understanding its depth.

A person may hear the command to love without practicing sacrificial love.

A person may hear the command to repent without actually turning away from sin.

A person may hear the teaching about prayer without entering into sincere prayer.

Therefore, the discovery of interpretation requires more than verbal comprehension.

It requires spiritual realization.

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6. Jesus Christ as the Living Divine Word

The foundation of the present interpretation is the Christian confession that Jesus Christ is the **Living Divine Word**.

John 1 provides the most direct biblical foundation:

“In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.”

John further says:

“Through him all things were made.”

And:

“In him was life, and that life was the light of all mankind.”

Finally:

“The Word became flesh.”

This theology presents the Word not as a dead text but as a living divine reality.

The Word is associated with:

- God,
- creation,
- life,
- light,
- revelation,
- incarnation,
- grace,
- truth.

This provides a powerful framework for the concept of the **Living Divine Word**.

Jesus is therefore understood as more than the author of teachings.

He is the person in whom divine revelation is embodied.

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7. The Living Word and Holy Words

If Christ is the Living Word, then His teachings have a distinctive theological character.

His words reveal the will of God.

His words expose sin.

His words call for repentance.

His words reveal mercy.

His words teach love.

His words teach forgiveness.

His words proclaim the Kingdom of God.

His words point toward eternal life.

His words teach humanity how to live.

Thus, the relationship can be expressed:

The Living Word speaks holy words, and the holy words reveal the way toward divine life.

The words of Christ therefore have both **revelatory** and **transformative** significance.

They reveal what is true.

They call the listener to become different.

---

8. The Holy Words and Holy Actions of Christ

One of the central ideas developed in this research is that the words of Jesus cannot be separated from His actions.

Jesus did not merely teach healing.

He healed.

Jesus did not merely teach compassion.

He showed compassion.

Jesus did not merely teach forgiveness.

He forgave.

Jesus did not merely speak about life.

He raised the dead.

Jesus did not merely speak about divine authority.

He demonstrated authority over disease, demons, and the forces of nature.

Jesus did not merely speak about the Kingdom.

He proclaimed the Kingdom of God.

Therefore:

The Living Divine Word performed holy living actions through His holy words and holy authority.

The Gospel narratives present Jesus' speech and action as deeply interconnected.

His words command.

His actions reveal.

His miracles confirm.

His life embodies.

His resurrection completes the Christian proclamation.

---

9. Christ Raising the Dead

The raising of the dead is particularly significant for the interpretation of Thomas 1.

The Gospel narratives describe Jesus restoring the dead to life, most famously Lazarus in John 11.

The theological significance becomes even more profound because Jesus does not merely perform a resurrection miracle.

He declares:

“I am the resurrection and the life.”

This means that resurrection is connected with the person of Jesus Himself.

Christ is not merely a messenger delivering information about resurrection.

He is presented as the source and embodiment of resurrection life.

This creates a powerful connection with Thomas 1:

Thomas 1: Whoever finds the interpretation will not taste death.

John 11: Jesus is the resurrection and the life.

The two statements are not identical, but they can be brought into theological conversation.

---

10. Christ Calming the Storm

The Gospel narratives also describe Jesus calming a storm.

The significance of this event extends beyond weather.

The storm represents forces that appear beyond human control.

Fear arises.

The disciples become overwhelmed.

Jesus commands the storm.

The waters become calm.

Within the theological framework of the Living Word, this demonstrates that Christ's word possesses authority over creation.

The Living Word speaks, and creation responds.

Thus, the miracle can be contemplated as another manifestation of the principle:

The Living Word speaks life and order into situations characterized by fear, chaos, and danger.

---

11. Christ Healing the Sick

Healing is one of the most visible aspects of Jesus' ministry.

The Gospels describe Jesus healing people suffering from various diseases and conditions.

These healing narratives reveal several dimensions of the Living Word.

11.1 Divine compassion

Christ responds to suffering.

11.2 Restoration

The sick person is restored to life and community.

11.3 Authority

Jesus acts with divine authority.

11.4 Faith

The Gospel narratives frequently associate healing with faith.

11.5 Holiness

The healing ministry demonstrates the movement from suffering toward wholeness.

Therefore, Christ can be contemplated as the **Holy Medicine** of the soul.

This is a theological metaphor.

It does not mean that medical treatment is unnecessary or that physical illness should be treated only through religious practice.

Rather, it means that Christ is understood as the deepest source of spiritual healing.

---

12. Christ as Holy Medicine

Human beings experience many forms of suffering.

There is physical suffering.

There is emotional suffering.

There is moral suffering.

There is spiritual suffering.

There is guilt.

There is fear.

There is alienation.

There is grief.

There is death.

Christian theology understands Christ as the one who addresses the deepest condition of humanity.

The metaphor of **Holy Medicine** therefore expresses the belief that Christ heals the human person at the deepest level.

The Living Word becomes:

Medicine for spiritual sickness.

Light for spiritual darkness.

Truth for spiritual confusion.

Forgiveness for the repentant.

Hope for the suffering.

Life in the presence of death.

---

13. Casting Out Demons and Evil Spirits

The Gospel narratives repeatedly describe Jesus confronting demons and evil spirits.

These accounts demonstrate that the ministry of Christ includes confrontation with spiritual evil.

Jesus commands evil spirits.

They obey.

This is significant for the theology of the Living Word.

The holy Word is presented as possessing authority over hostile spiritual powers.

Therefore:

The Living Word is not powerless before evil.

Christ's authority represents the triumph of divine holiness over spiritual darkness.

This becomes important when considering the later themes of Satan, hell, judgment, and victory over death.

---

14. The Living Word and Satan

Christian Scripture presents Satan as an adversarial spiritual power.

The ministry of Jesus includes confrontation with temptation and evil.

Christ resists temptation.

Christ defeats demonic opposition.

Christ teaches people to turn away from evil.

Christ ultimately becomes central to the Christian proclamation of victory over sin and death.

Thus, the Living Word is understood as the divine answer to the powers of darkness.

The movement can be expressed:

darkness → light

sin → repentance

bondage → freedom

evil → holiness

death → resurrection

---

15. The Holy Words Teach How to Live

The purpose of Christ's teachings is not merely to provide information about theology.

His teachings provide a way of living.

The holy words teach:

Love

To love God and neighbor.

Forgiveness

To forgive those who have wronged us.

Mercy

To show compassion toward suffering people.

Charity

To give to those in need.

Peace

To pursue reconciliation.

Humility

To reject pride.

Repentance

To turn away from sin.

Prayer

To maintain communion with God.

Holiness

To live according to God's will.

Righteousness

To pursue what is good and just.

Faith

To trust God.

Eternal life

To seek the life that comes from God.

Therefore, the interpretation of Christ's words becomes a **manner of living**.

---

16. Implementation of the Holy Words

The central theological contribution of this research is the emphasis on **implementation**.

The holy words must become holy actions.

It is possible to know a command without obeying it.

It is possible to admire Jesus without following His teaching.

It is possible to read Scripture without changing one's life.

Therefore, interpretation is incomplete without implementation.

The principle can be expressed:

A word understood but not practiced has not reached its full spiritual purpose.

The implementation of Christ's teachings may be represented as:

Hear → Understand → Believe → Practice → Transform → Become Holy.

This does not mean that human works mechanically earn salvation.

Rather, within the Christian theological framework, transformed conduct is understood as a response to God's grace and a manifestation of genuine faith.

---

17. Love as Implementation

Love is central to Christian ethics.

The person who understands the teaching of Christ about love must attempt to embody love.

Love means more than emotional affection.

It includes:

- mercy,
- patience,
- forgiveness,
- service,
- charity,
- compassion,
- humility,
- sacrifice.

The implementation of Christ's words therefore changes interpersonal relationships.

Instead of hatred:

love.

Instead of revenge:

forgiveness.

Instead of cruelty:

mercy.

Instead of selfishness:

charity.

Instead of hostility:

peace.

This transformation is evidence of the Living Word becoming active in human life.

---

18. Forgiveness as Holy Discipline

Forgiveness is one of the most difficult applications of Christ's teaching.

The person who has been harmed naturally experiences anger and pain.

Yet Christ teaches forgiveness.

Forgiveness does not mean that evil becomes good.

It does not mean that injustice should be ignored.

It does not mean that victims should remain in dangerous circumstances.

Rather, in Christian theology, forgiveness is a rejection of the desire to perpetuate hatred and revenge.

The believer entrusts ultimate judgment to God while seeking freedom from destructive hatred.

Thus, forgiveness becomes a spiritual discipline.

---

19. Repentance and Confession

The implementation of Christ's words necessarily involves confronting one's own sin.

Repentance is a turning.

A person recognizes wrongdoing and turns toward God.

Confession gives expression to that recognition.

Repentance therefore involves:

recognition → confession → turning → forgiveness → transformation.

The person does not merely say that sin is wrong.

The person seeks to leave sin behind.

This is essential to the interpretation of the Living Word because Christ's teaching repeatedly calls people toward transformation.

---

20. Holy Prayer

Prayer is another essential implementation of Christ's teaching.

Prayer is communion with God.

Through prayer, the believer seeks:

- forgiveness,
- guidance,
- wisdom,
- strength,
- protection,
- holiness,
- compassion,
- spiritual understanding.

The person seeking the interpretation of the Living Word therefore does not rely solely upon intellectual study.

The person also prays for understanding.

The prayer may be expressed:

“Blessed Holy Lord Jesus Christ, help me understand Your holy words and implement their meaning in my life.”

Prayer therefore connects interpretation with spiritual practice.

---

21. Divine Grace

The implementation of Christ's words leads, within this theological framework, toward **Divine Grace**.

Grace is God's gracious action toward humanity.

The believer does not claim to become holy solely through personal power.

The Christian life depends upon God's grace.

The Gospel of John explicitly connects Christ with grace and truth.

Thus, the relationship may be represented:

Christ → Holy Words → Faithful Response → Divine Grace → Transformation.

Grace is therefore not simply a reward for perfect behavior.

It is the divine gift through which the believer is enabled to live in relationship with God.

---

22. Guidance of the Holy Spirit

The Holy Spirit occupies a central place in Christian theology.

The Spirit guides the believer toward truth and holiness.

Therefore, the person attempting to implement Christ's words seeks not merely external obedience but internal transformation through the Spirit.

The theological sequence becomes:

Holy Word → Understanding → Prayer → Holy Spirit → Guidance → Holy Life.

The guidance of the Holy Spirit may be understood as helping the believer:

- recognize sin,
- seek repentance,
- understand Scripture,
- practice love,
- forgive,
- resist temptation,
- pursue holiness,
- remain faithful to God.

Thus, the implementation of Christ's teachings is understood as a life lived under Divine Grace and guided by the Holy Spirit.

---

23. The Kingdom of God

Jesus repeatedly proclaimed the Kingdom of God.

The Kingdom represents God's reign and God's purposes.

The person who follows the Living Word therefore seeks to orient life toward God's Kingdom.

This changes the meaning of success.

Worldly success is temporary.

Earthly possessions are temporary.

Physical life is temporary.

The Kingdom of God represents an eternal horizon.

The interpretation of the holy words therefore directs the believer beyond temporary worldly concerns toward God's eternal purposes.

---

24. Heaven and Eternal Life

The theological framework developed in this paper understands Heaven as the fulfillment of communion with God.

The promise of eternal life is therefore not merely endless biological existence.

It is life with God.

The Living Word reveals the way toward that life.

John's Gospel repeatedly connects belief in Christ with life.

Jesus declares Himself to be the resurrection and the life.

Therefore, eternal life is fundamentally Christ-centered.

The believer does not merely seek an eternal place.

The believer seeks eternal communion with God through Christ.

---

25. The Meaning of “Not Taste Death”

The phrase “will not taste death” is the central theological mystery of Saying 1.

Physical human beings ordinarily die.

Therefore, the statement should not automatically be interpreted as meaning that a believer's physical body will never die.

Christian Scripture itself recognizes physical death.

John 11:25 provides an important parallel:

“I am the resurrection and the life. The one who believes in me will live, even though they die.”

This distinction is crucial.

Physical death may occur.

Yet Christian hope declares that death does not have ultimate authority.

Thus:

physical death ≠ ultimate defeat.

The Christian hope is resurrection.

The Living Word is the source of that hope.

---

26. Resurrection as Victory

The resurrection of Jesus stands at the center of Christian faith.

Christ's resurrection means that death is not the final word.

The Living Word enters death and emerges victorious.

Therefore, the phrase “not taste death” can be interpreted within Christian theology as a statement concerning ultimate victory over death.

The believer may experience physical death.

But death cannot finally destroy the life that God gives.

This is the theological meaning of victory over death.

---

27. The Soul and Death

The concept of the immortal soul requires careful theological qualification.

Different Christian traditions have different approaches to the relationship between soul, body, death, resurrection, and immortality.

The present research adopts the theological perspective expressed in the author's framework: the soul is created for God and is therefore understood in relation to eternal existence.

However, Christian hope is not limited to an immortal soul surviving independently of the body.

The doctrine of resurrection remains fundamental.

Therefore, the Christian hope includes the restoration and transformation of human existence through God's power.

The deepest problem is not merely physical death.

It is separation from God.

The Living Word offers reconciliation and life.

---

28. Hell and Divine Judgment

Hell is a serious theme within Christian Scripture.

Matthew 25:41 describes eternal fire prepared for the devil and his angels.

This provides biblical grounding for the theological idea that hell is associated with divine judgment upon Satan and the powers of evil.

The author's theological framework additionally understands hell in relation to sinners who persist in evil and reject God.

The punishment of hell is understood as horrible because it represents divine judgment and separation from God.

However, it is important to distinguish this doctrine from Thomas 1.

Thomas 1 does not itself explain the Christian doctrine of hell.

The doctrine comes from the broader biblical and theological tradition.

The present paper incorporates it because the theme of death in Thomas 1 becomes more meaningful when considered alongside the broader Christian contrast between:

life with God

and

judgment and separation from God.

---

29. Hell as Punishment for Evil

Within the theological framework of this paper, hell is understood as associated with punishment for:

- Satan,
- demons,
- evil spiritual powers,
- persistent evil,
- unrepentant sinners.

Matthew 25:41 specifically speaks of eternal fire prepared for the devil and his angels.

The important theological principle is that evil does not possess equal status with God.

God is the source of holiness and life.

Evil stands under divine judgment.

Thus:

God's holiness → life

persistent rebellion → judgment

The doctrine of hell therefore emphasizes the seriousness of evil.

---

30. The Horrible Punishment of Hell

The biblical imagery associated with hell is intentionally severe.

Scripture uses imagery involving:

- fire,
- darkness,
- exclusion,
- destruction,
- judgment,
- anguish.

The purpose of such imagery is to communicate the seriousness of rejecting God and persisting in evil.

The present research describes hell as **horrible punishment** because that is central to the theological framework being developed.

However, the exact metaphysical nature of hell has been debated throughout Christian history.

Some traditions emphasize eternal conscious punishment.

Others have developed doctrines of destruction or annihilation.

Others emphasize separation from God.

The paper therefore distinguishes the author's theological understanding from a claim that every Christian tradition interprets hell identically.

---

31. Sin and Spiritual Death

Sin can be understood as opposition to God's holy will.

It damages the relationship between humanity and God.

The theological language of “spiritual death” therefore describes a condition in which the human person is separated from the life of God.

The Living Word confronts this condition.

Christ calls sinners to repentance.

Christ offers forgiveness.

Christ restores relationship with God.

Thus:

Sin → spiritual death

Christ → reconciliation

repentance → restoration

grace → new life

---

32. The Living Word and Victory Over Satan

The victory of Christ is not limited to individual moral improvement.

Christian theology understands Christ as victorious over the powers of evil.

The New Testament presents the cross and resurrection as decisive events in God's victory.

The Living Word therefore becomes the center of the struggle between:

light and darkness

life and death

holiness and evil

God and rebellion

The final victory belongs to God.

This gives theological meaning to the phrase:

The holy words of the Living Divine Word conquered hell, death, and Satan.

Strictly speaking, this sentence is a theological synthesis rather than a quotation from Thomas 1.

It expresses the author's interpretation of Christ's work within the wider Christian narrative.

---

33. The Word as Light

John's Gospel associates the Word with light.

The light shines in darkness.

The darkness does not overcome it.

This is an especially powerful image for the Living Divine Word.

Darkness represents ignorance, sin, fear, evil, and death.

Light represents truth, holiness, knowledge, revelation, and life.

Therefore, discovering the interpretation of Christ's words can be understood as moving from darkness toward light.

The person who understands the holy words begins to see reality differently.

---

34. Knowledge and Transformation

Knowledge is not sufficient by itself.

A person may possess extensive theological knowledge and still fail to practice love.

A person may memorize Scripture and still refuse forgiveness.

A person may discuss holiness without living a holy life.

Therefore, this research distinguishes between:

information

and

transformative knowledge.

Transformative knowledge changes the person.

The meaning of Thomas 1 can therefore be expressed:

The true interpretation of the Living Word is knowledge that produces life.

---

35. From Interpretation to Implementation

The central model of this research is:

Stage 1 — Hearing

The person encounters Christ's words.

Stage 2 — Seeking

The person actively searches for their meaning.

Stage 3 — Interpretation

The person discovers their deeper significance.

Stage 4 — Faith

The person receives the teaching with trust.

Stage 5 — Implementation

The person puts the teaching into practice.

Stage 6 — Transformation

The person's character begins to change.

Stage 7 — Holiness

The person seeks a life aligned with God.

Stage 8 — Grace

The person depends upon Divine Grace.

Stage 9 — Holy Spirit

The person seeks the Spirit's guidance.

Stage 10 — Life

The person participates in the life offered by God.

Stage 11 — Resurrection

The believer hopes for resurrection.

Stage 12 — Victory Over Death

Death no longer has the final word.

This twelve-stage model represents the author's theological synthesis.

---

36. Living the Words of Christ

The concept of “living the words” is fundamental.

Christ's teaching becomes a practical spiritual discipline.

For example:

If Christ teaches forgiveness:

I must practice forgiveness.

If Christ teaches love:

I must practice love.

If Christ teaches charity:

I must practice charity.

If Christ teaches prayer:

I must pray.

If Christ teaches repentance:

I must repent.

If Christ teaches holiness:

I must pursue holiness.

If Christ teaches peace:

I must pursue peace.

The interpretation therefore becomes visible through conduct.

---

37. Holy Discipline

The holy life requires discipline.

Spiritual discipline may include:

- regular prayer,
- Scripture study,
- repentance,
- confession,
- forgiveness,
- charity,
- fasting according to one's Christian tradition,
- self-control,
- service,
- humility,
- avoidance of deliberate evil,
- seeking God's guidance.

Discipline does not mean earning God's love through human perfection.

Rather, it represents a person's response to God's grace.

The believer seeks to become increasingly conformed to the teachings of Christ.

---

38. The Living Word and Human Relationships

The implementation of Christ's words affects relationships.

A Christian interpretation of Christ's teachings therefore extends beyond private spirituality.

It influences:

- family relationships,
- friendships,
- community,
- treatment of strangers,
- treatment of the poor,
- treatment of enemies,
- treatment of the suffering.

The Living Word transforms the believer's relationship with other human beings.

This is why love, mercy, forgiveness, and charity are essential.

---

39. Charity as Evidence of Holy Life

Charity is more than financial giving.

It includes:

- helping the poor,
- feeding the hungry,
- caring for the suffering,
- supporting the vulnerable,
- giving time,
- showing compassion,
- serving others.

A person who claims to understand Christ's words but refuses compassion has not fully implemented their ethical meaning.

Charity therefore becomes an expression of the Living Word in action.

---

40. Peace and Forgiveness

The Living Word teaches a path away from hatred and revenge.

Peace does not simply mean absence of conflict.

It involves reconciliation and a willingness to seek what is good.

Forgiveness becomes a central spiritual practice.

The person who forgives participates in a divine pattern of mercy.

The person who seeks peace embodies the teachings of Christ.

Thus:

The holy words become holy relationships.

---

41. The Role of Faith

Faith is essential to Christian interpretation.

The believer does not merely study Jesus as an ancient historical figure.

The believer encounters Jesus as Lord and Living Word.

Faith therefore transforms the purpose of interpretation.

The question becomes:

“What does this text mean?”

and also:

“What is Christ calling me to become?”

The first is intellectual.

The second is spiritual.

The Christian theological interpretation requires both.

---

42. Christ as Lord

The title **Lord Jesus Christ** expresses a confession of faith.

Jesus is not merely a teacher among many teachers.

He is confessed as Lord.

This means that His words possess authority.

The believer therefore approaches His teaching with reverence.

The interpretation of His words is not simply academic curiosity.

It becomes an act of discipleship.

---

43. The Living Word and the Holy Spirit

The Christian doctrine of the Trinity provides a broader theological context.

The Father is God.

The Son is the Living Word.

The Holy Spirit guides and sanctifies.

The three are understood within Christian theology in relation to the one God.

The present paper does not claim that Thomas 1 explicitly teaches this doctrine.

Rather, the doctrine provides the theological context within which the author's understanding of the Living Word, Divine Grace, and Holy Spirit is developed.

---

44. Divine Grace and Human Response

A theological tension must be maintained.

Human beings are called to act.

Yet salvation is not presented as a human achievement independent of God.

The believer responds to grace.

The believer seeks holiness through grace.

The believer repents through grace.

The believer receives guidance through the Holy Spirit.

Thus:

Grace does not eliminate human response; grace enables and transforms human response.

This principle prevents the interpretation of Thomas 1 from becoming merely a system of moral self-improvement.

The ultimate source of life remains God.

---

45. The Living Word as Divine Revelation

The Living Word reveals God.

Christ reveals:

- God's character,
- God's mercy,
- God's holiness,
- God's love,
- God's Kingdom,
- God's judgment,
- God's purpose for humanity.

The holy words are therefore revelatory.

They disclose what humanity could not fully discover through ordinary human reasoning alone.

---

46. The Living Word and Truth

Jesus' teachings are also connected with truth.

The believer therefore seeks truth rather than deception.

Truth requires honesty.

Truth requires humility.

Truth requires willingness to confront sin.

Truth requires rejection of falsehood.

The person seeking the interpretation of the Living Word must therefore be willing to allow Christ's teaching to challenge personal assumptions.

Interpretation cannot simply mean making the text say whatever one wants.

It requires serious engagement with the words.

---

47. The Danger of False Interpretation

The emphasis on interpretation creates a corresponding danger.

If a person can claim any meaning whatsoever, then “interpretation” becomes arbitrary.

Therefore, a responsible theological interpretation requires attention to:

- the actual text,
- historical context,
- language,
- canonical Scripture,
- Christian theological tradition,
- literary context,
- ethical consequences.

The present paper therefore identifies its own synthesis as a **theological interpretation**, rather than claiming that it is the only possible historical interpretation of Thomas 1.

---

48. Thomas 1 and the Gospel of John

Thomas and John should not be treated as identical texts.

They come from different literary traditions.

Thomas is a sayings collection.

John is a narrative Gospel with a highly developed theological presentation of Jesus.

Nevertheless, there are important conceptual connections.

Thomas 1:

interpretation of sayings → not tasting death.

John:

Word → life → light.

John 11:

Jesus → resurrection and life.

John 14:

Jesus → way, truth, and life.

These connections allow a Christian theological dialogue between the texts.

---

49. Thomas 1 and John 8

A particularly interesting comparison concerns John 8:51–52.

Jesus says, in the Johannine account, that whoever keeps His word will never see death. His opponents respond by speaking of tasting death.

This provides a striking textual parallel with Thomas 1's language concerning not tasting death.

However, the difference remains significant.

John emphasizes **keeping Christ's word**.

Thomas 1 emphasizes **finding its interpretation**.

This difference suggests that Thomas places particular emphasis on understanding, while John integrates the promise with discipleship and obedience.

The present research brings the two together:

True interpretation should lead to faithful implementation.

Understanding without obedience is incomplete.

---

50. Thomas 1 and the Meaning of Life

Thomas 1 ultimately asks what kind of knowledge leads to life.

The present research answers:

knowledge of the Living Word.

But knowledge here means more than information.

It means:

understanding + faith + transformation + implementation.

The person who discovers the meaning of Christ's words discovers a path toward life.

---

51. Theological Model of the Living Divine Word

The complete theological model proposed by this research is:

I. The Person

Jesus Christ — the Living Divine Word

↓

II. The Revelation

Holy words of Christ

↓

III. The Discovery

Interpretation and understanding

↓

IV. The Response

Faith

↓

V. The Turning

Repentance

↓

VI. The Discipline

Prayer, confession, holiness, righteousness

↓

VII. The Practice

Love, forgiveness, mercy, peace, charity

↓

VIII. The Divine Assistance

Grace

↓

IX. The Divine Guidance

Holy Spirit

↓

X. The Hope

Kingdom of God and Heaven

↓

XI. The Victory

Resurrection

↓

XII. The Final Promise

Victory over death and eternal life

---

52. Theological Proposition I

Proposition

Jesus Christ is the Living Divine Word.

Basis

John 1 identifies the Word with God and declares that the Word became flesh.

Interpretation

Christ is therefore understood as the embodied Divine Word.

---

53. Theological Proposition II

Proposition

The holy words of the Living Divine Word reveal the path toward divine life.

Basis

Jesus' teachings address repentance, love, forgiveness, prayer, holiness, and the Kingdom of God.

Interpretation

The words are understood as transformative rather than merely informational.

---

54. Theological Proposition III

Proposition

The interpretation of Christ's words should lead to implementation.

Basis

Christian discipleship involves following Christ, not merely hearing Him.

Interpretation

True interpretation becomes a way of life.

---

55. Theological Proposition IV

Proposition

Implementation of Christ's teachings leads the believer toward Divine Grace and dependence upon God.

Basis

Christian theology understands salvation and sanctification as dependent upon God's grace.

Interpretation

Holy living is a response to grace rather than a replacement for grace.

---

56. Theological Proposition V

Proposition

The Holy Spirit guides the believer toward holiness.

Basis

The New Testament presents the Holy Spirit as an active divine presence in Christian life.

Interpretation

The implementation of Christ's teachings is understood as a Spirit-guided transformation.

---

57. Theological Proposition VI

Proposition

Christ is the Resurrection and the Life.

Basis

John 11:25 explicitly presents Jesus in these terms.

Interpretation

Thomas 1's promise concerning death can therefore be interpreted within the broader Christian framework of resurrection life.

---

58. Theological Proposition VII

Proposition

Evil does not have ultimate authority over the Living Word.

Basis

The Gospel narratives depict Jesus confronting demons, temptation, sin, and death.

Interpretation

Christ represents divine victory over spiritual darkness.

---

59. Theological Proposition VIII

Proposition

Divine judgment gives moral seriousness to the call toward holiness.

Basis

The New Testament contains teachings concerning judgment and hell, including Matthew 25:41.

Interpretation

The promise of life is accompanied by a warning concerning the consequences of persistent evil.

---

60. The Meaning of Victory Over Death

Victory over death should not be reduced to physical immortality.

Christian resurrection theology is more comprehensive.

It includes:

- victory over sin,
- reconciliation with God,
- resurrection,
- eternal life,
- the final defeat of death.

The Living Word therefore represents the complete answer to the human condition.

---

61. Death as the Great Human Enemy

Human beings experience death as the ultimate boundary.

No human power can permanently overcome it.

Science can extend life.

Medicine can treat disease.

Human society can improve living conditions.

But death remains.

Christianity proclaims that Christ has confronted death itself.

The resurrection therefore becomes the ultimate manifestation of divine life.

---

62. “Will Not Taste Death” as a Promise

The phrase can therefore be interpreted in several layers.

First layer: Spiritual life

The believer receives life from God.

Second layer: Freedom from spiritual death

Sin no longer possesses ultimate authority.

Third layer: Resurrection

Physical death does not eliminate the promise of life.

Fourth layer: Eternal life

The believer hopes for eternal communion with God.

These layers should not be confused with the literal claim that believers will never physically die.

---

63. The Holy Life as Preparation for Eternal Life

The implementation of Christ's teachings shapes the believer's present life while orienting it toward eternity.

Holiness is therefore both:

present discipline

and

future hope.

The believer begins living according to God's Kingdom now while awaiting its ultimate fulfillment.

---

64. The Soul's Journey Toward God

Within the theological framework of this research, the soul is understood as oriented toward God.

The spiritual journey involves:

creation → earthly life → moral choice → repentance → grace → holiness → death → resurrection → eternal life.

Hell represents the terrifying opposite: divine judgment associated with persistent rebellion against God.

This framework emphasizes the seriousness of spiritual choices.

---

65. Why the Interpretation Matters

If the interpretation of Christ's words is associated with victory over death, then interpretation becomes spiritually significant.

It is not merely a scholarly exercise.

The reader is being asked to decide how the words should transform life.

This creates a bridge between theology and ethics.

The study of Christ's words should lead to:

better understanding

and

better living.

---

66. The Living Word and Ethical Transformation

A genuine encounter with the Living Word should affect character.

It should produce:

- greater compassion,
- greater humility,
- greater forgiveness,
- greater self-control,
- greater charity,
- greater concern for the suffering,
- greater commitment to truth,
- greater devotion to God.

This is the practical dimension of the interpretation.

---

67. The Living Word and Spiritual Medicine

The metaphor of medicine can be expanded.

Humanity is spiritually wounded by:

sin

hatred

pride

greed

fear

violence

unforgiveness

despair

The teachings of Christ offer a different way:

repentance

humility

love

charity

forgiveness

peace

hope

The Living Word therefore becomes spiritual medicine that directs the soul toward healing.

---

68. The Living Word and Holy Miracles

Miracles are not merely spectacles.

Within Christian theology, they signify something.

Healing signifies restoration.

Raising the dead signifies life.

Casting out demons signifies freedom.

Calming the storm signifies divine authority.

Feeding the hungry signifies divine provision.

Forgiving sins signifies mercy.

The miracles therefore communicate through action what Christ communicates through words.

---

69. Word and Action

This produces a central principle:

The holy word and the holy action belong together.

Christ teaches love and demonstrates love.

Christ teaches mercy and demonstrates mercy.

Christ teaches forgiveness and demonstrates forgiveness.

Christ teaches life and gives life.

Christ teaches the Kingdom and proclaims the Kingdom.

The believer is called to imitate this unity of word and action.

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70. A Christian Anthropology of the Living Word

Human beings are understood as creatures capable of responding to God.

They possess moral responsibility.

They can turn toward God or away from God.

The Living Word therefore addresses the human person.

The human response can be:

rejection

or

reception.

The theological purpose of interpretation is to move toward faithful reception.

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71. Reception of the Holy Word

To receive the holy word means:

hearing it

understanding it

believing it

loving it

obeying it

living it.

This is why the implementation of Christ's teachings occupies such an important position in the present research.

---

72. The Living Word and Spiritual Discipline

Spiritual discipline protects interpretation from remaining theoretical.

A person can establish practices that reinforce the holy life:

Daily prayer

Seeking God's presence.

Scripture reading

Studying the words of Christ.

Repentance

Regularly examining one's life.

Forgiveness

Releasing hatred.

Charity

Serving others.

Self-control

Resisting sinful desires.

Humility

Recognizing dependence upon God.

Silence and contemplation

Listening inwardly for God's guidance.

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73. The Role of Charity

Charity demonstrates that interpretation has become action.

The believer who sees another person suffering is called to respond.

The Kingdom of God is therefore not simply an abstract doctrine.

It produces practical compassion.

Charity becomes an expression of the Living Word.

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74. The Role of Mercy

Mercy is another manifestation of God's character.

A person who understands God's mercy seeks to show mercy.

The believer therefore becomes an instrument through which the love of Christ reaches others.

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75. The Role of Peace

Peace is not weakness.

Peace requires strength to reject revenge.

The person who implements Christ's words seeks reconciliation whenever possible.

This creates communities shaped by the values of the Kingdom.

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76. The Role of Holiness

Holiness means belonging to God and being set apart for God's purposes.

The believer therefore seeks to purify conduct, intention, thought, and relationships.

Holiness is not merely external behavior.

It concerns the heart.

The Living Word therefore transforms both outward actions and inward motivations.

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77. The Role of Humility

Humility protects the believer from spiritual pride.

A person who thinks they have perfectly understood Christ's words may stop seeking.

But Thomas begins with seeking and finding.

Therefore, interpretation should remain accompanied by humility.

The believer can say:

“I seek to understand, but I remain dependent upon God's grace.”

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78. The Living Word and Wisdom

The search for interpretation resembles a search for wisdom.

The believer seeks not merely knowledge of words but wisdom concerning how to live.

Wisdom asks:

What is good?

What is holy?

What leads toward God?

What leads toward destruction?

How should I treat another person?

How should I respond to suffering?

How should I respond to evil?

The Living Word provides the foundation for these questions.

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79. The Relationship Between Truth and Life

Truth and life are interconnected.

Falsehood can produce destruction.

Truth can lead toward freedom.

The Christian proclamation identifies Christ with truth and life.

Therefore, the interpretation of His words is simultaneously a search for truth and a search for life.

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80. The Living Word and Freedom

Christ's teaching offers freedom from destructive patterns.

Freedom from:

hatred

revenge

sin

fear

spiritual darkness

despair

This freedom is not simply permission to do whatever one wants.

It is freedom to live according to God's good purpose.

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81. The Living Word and Human Suffering

The existence of suffering creates a major theological question.

Why does a world created by God contain disease, violence, death, and evil?

The ministry of Christ does not remove all suffering immediately.

But Christ enters human suffering.

He heals.

He comforts.

He weeps.

He forgives.

He suffers.

He dies.

He rises.

Thus, the Living Word does not remain distant from human suffering.

The Christian message is that God enters the human condition and ultimately overcomes death.

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82. The Cross and the Living Word

The cross represents the apparent defeat of Jesus.

The Living Word is crucified.

From a purely human perspective, death appears victorious.

But Christian faith interprets the cross together with resurrection.

The cross therefore becomes part of the path toward victory.

The Living Word passes through death rather than being defeated by it.

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83. Resurrection and the Defeat of Death

The resurrection changes the meaning of the cross.

Death is not the end.

The grave is not the final destination.

The Living Word lives.

Therefore, the Christian hope of eternal life is grounded in the resurrection of Christ.

This provides the deepest theological context for the phrase:

“will not taste death.”

---

84. The Final Defeat of Death

Christian Scripture ultimately looks toward the defeat of death itself.

The theological story therefore moves from:

creation

to

incarnation

to

ministry

to

cross

to

resurrection

to

eternal life

to

final victory.

The Living Word stands at the center of this movement.

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85. The Comprehensive Spiritual Formula

The research can now be summarized in one formula:

Jesus Christ = Living Divine Word

Living Divine Word → Holy Words

Holy Words → Divine Teaching

Divine Teaching → Interpretation

Interpretation → Faithful Implementation

Implementation → Repentance + Holiness + Love + Prayer + Mercy + Charity

Holy Life → Dependence upon Divine Grace

Divine Grace → Guidance of the Holy Spirit

Holy Spirit → Spiritual Transformation

Spiritual Transformation → Life in God

Life in God → Resurrection Hope

Resurrection Hope → Victory Over Death

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86. Comparison Table

Theme	Thomas 1	Canonical Christian Theology	Present Interpretation

Jesus' sayings	Their interpretation is significant	Jesus' teachings reveal God's will	Holy words requiring implementation
Interpretation	Explicitly emphasized	Scripture requires understanding	Spiritual discovery
Death	Not tasting death	Death is overcome through Christ	Victory over spiritual and ultimate death
Word	Saying itself does not explicitly identify Jesus as Logos	John identifies Christ as the Word	Jesus as Living Divine Word
Life	Associated with interpretation	Christ is source of life	Holy words lead toward life
Resurrection	Not developed explicitly in Saying 1	Central Christian doctrine	Fulfillment of victory over death
Grace	Not explicitly explained in Saying 1	Central Christian concept	Divine assistance for holy life
Holy Spirit	Not mentioned in Saying 1	Central New Testament doctrine	Guidance in implementing Christ's words
Hell	Not explained in Saying 1	Taught elsewhere in Scripture	Judgment associated with persistent evil
Satan	Not mentioned in Saying 1	Present in broader Christian theology	Enemy conquered through Christ
Holiness	Not explicitly stated in Saying 1	Major biblical theme	Practical outcome of Christ's teaching
Charity	Not stated in Saying 1	Central Christian ethic	Implementation of holy words

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87. Original Contribution of This Research

The principal contribution of this research is the development of the concept of **implementation of interpretation**.

Thomas 1 emphasizes finding the interpretation.

This research proposes:

Interpretation reaches its spiritual fullness when it becomes implementation.

The movement is therefore:

interpretation → implementation → transformation.

This gives practical meaning to the saying.

The reader is not merely asked:

“What does Jesus mean?”

The reader is asked:

“How should I live because of what Jesus means?”

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88. Theological Significance

The significance of this interpretation is that it unites several aspects of Christian spirituality:

Christology

Jesus as the Living Divine Word.

Soteriology

Christ as the source of salvation and life.

Pneumatology

The Holy Spirit as guide.

Ethics

Love, mercy, forgiveness, charity, holiness.

Eschatology

Resurrection, judgment, Heaven, eternal life.

Spirituality

Prayer, repentance, confession, discipline.

Demonology

Christ's authority over demons and Satan.

These themes are united around one central person:

Jesus Christ, the Living Divine Word.

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89. Limitations of the Research

Several limitations should be acknowledged.

First, Thomas 1 is a very short saying.

It cannot independently establish every theological proposition developed in this paper.

Second, the *Gospel of Thomas* and the canonical Gospels are distinct literary works.

Third, scholars disagree about the date, sources, theological character, and relationship of Thomas to the Synoptic and Johannine traditions.

Fourth, Christian traditions disagree about several theological questions, especially the nature of hell, the soul, and the precise relationship between grace and human action.

Therefore, the present work should be understood as a **Christian theological interpretation**, specifically the theological framework identified here as **[Pawan Upadhyay Bible]**, rather than as a claim that every conclusion represents universal Christian or academic consensus.

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90. Proposed Research Findings

The research produces the following findings.

Finding 1

Thomas 1 makes interpretation central to the reception of Jesus' sayings.

Finding 2

The saying associates discovery of meaning with overcoming death.

Finding 3

John provides a particularly important Christian framework for interpreting Jesus as the Divine Word.

Finding 4

The canonical Gospels portray Jesus' words and actions as inseparable manifestations of His ministry.

Finding 5

Christ's healing, deliverance, miracles, and resurrection can be interpreted as manifestations of divine life.

Finding 6

Understanding Christ's words should lead to implementation in Christian discipleship.

Finding 7

Implementation involves repentance, prayer, holiness, love, forgiveness, mercy, peace, charity, and righteousness.

Finding 8

The Christian life is understood as dependent upon Divine Grace.

Finding 9

The Holy Spirit is understood as guiding the believer toward truth and holiness.

Finding 10

The promise of life beyond death is illuminated by the Christian doctrine of resurrection.

Finding 11

Christian Scripture presents divine judgment and hell as serious realities, including judgment associated with Satan and his angels.

Finding 12

The ultimate Christian hope is not merely escape from physical death but resurrection and eternal life with God.

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91. Final Theological Synthesis

The entire research may be condensed into the following statement:

Jesus Christ is the Living Divine Word.

The Living Word speaks holy words.

The Living Word performs holy actions.

The Living Word heals.

The Living Word raises the dead.

The Living Word calms the storm.

The Living Word casts out demons and evil spirits.

The Living Word teaches repentance.

The Living Word teaches confession.

The Living Word teaches prayer.

The Living Word teaches holiness.

The Living Word teaches righteousness.

The Living Word teaches love.

The Living Word teaches forgiveness.

The Living Word teaches mercy.

The Living Word teaches peace.

The Living Word teaches charity.

The Living Word teaches about Heaven and the Kingdom of God.

The Living Word reveals the path toward eternal life.

The Living Word confronts sin and evil.

The Living Word conquers death through resurrection.

Therefore, the interpretation of His words cannot remain merely intellectual.

The holy words must be received.

The holy words must be understood.

The holy words must be implemented.

The implementation of the holy words becomes a holy way of life.

The believer seeks Divine Grace.

The believer seeks the guidance of the Holy Spirit.

The believer seeks holiness.

The believer seeks the Kingdom of God.

The believer hopes for resurrection.

And the believer trusts that death does not have the final word.

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92. Conclusion

The first saying of the *Gospel of Thomas* is only a single sentence, but it contains a profound question:

What does it mean to find the interpretation of the words of Jesus?

The present research proposes that the answer begins with the identity of Jesus as the **Living Divine Word**.

The Gospel of John provides the theological foundation for this concept by identifying the Word with God, associating the Word with life and light, and declaring that the Word became flesh.

When this theology is placed alongside Thomas 1, the interpretation of Jesus' words becomes a search for the meaning of divine life.

The words of Jesus are not merely information.

They are teachings that call for transformation.

They teach humanity how to live.

They call people toward repentance, confession, prayer, holiness, love, forgiveness, mercy, peace, charity, righteousness, and devotion to God.

But the meaning of the holy words becomes complete only when they are implemented.

Therefore:

The holy words are heard by the ears, understood by the mind, received by the heart, and manifested through a holy life.

This implementation occurs within the framework of Divine Grace.

The believer does not claim to achieve holiness independently of God.

The believer seeks God's grace.

The believer seeks the guidance of the Holy Spirit.

The believer seeks to become increasingly transformed according to the teachings of Christ.

The miracles of Jesus further illuminate this understanding.

He healed the sick.

He restored the suffering.

He cast out demons.

He commanded storms.

He raised the dead.

These actions demonstrate, within Christian faith, the authority and life-giving character of the Living Word.

Christ is therefore contemplated as the Holy Medicine of humanity—not as a replacement for physical medicine, but as the spiritual source of healing, forgiveness, restoration, and eternal hope.

The theme of death reaches its climax in the resurrection.

Jesus declares:

“I am the resurrection and the life.”

The believer may experience physical death, but Christian faith teaches that death is not the final authority.

The resurrection of Christ is understood as the decisive victory over death.

Therefore, the mysterious promise of Thomas 1—

“Whoever finds the interpretation of these sayings will not taste death”

—can be contemplated within a Christian theological framework as a promise concerning participation in divine life.

The doctrine of judgment provides the corresponding warning.

Christian Scripture speaks of divine judgment and describes eternal fire prepared for the devil and his angels. Hell therefore represents a serious theological reality associated with divine judgment and the consequences of persistent evil. Yet Thomas 1 itself does not explain this doctrine, and the present paper has therefore treated hell as part of the wider Christian theological framework.

The ultimate contrast is therefore:

Life or death.

Light or darkness.

Holiness or persistent evil.

Repentance or rebellion.

Communion with God or separation from God.

Resurrection or destruction.

At the center of the Christian answer stands Jesus Christ.

The Living Divine Word.

The Holy Teacher.

The Healer.

The Deliverer.

The Lord.

The Resurrection.

The Life.

Therefore, the deepest interpretation proposed by this research is:

To find the interpretation of the words of the Living Divine Word is to discover their divine meaning, receive them with faith, implement them through a holy life, seek Divine Grace and the guidance of the Holy Spirit, and walk toward the life revealed by Jesus Christ.

The words of Christ therefore do not remain merely written words.

They become a path.

A path from ignorance to understanding.

A path from sin to repentance.

A path from hatred to love.

A path from unforgiveness to mercy.

A path from darkness to light.

A path from spiritual death to life.

A path from fear to hope.

A path from the grave toward resurrection.

And ultimately:

A path toward victory over death.

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93. Author's Central Theological Statement

✝️ [Pawan Upadhyay Bible]

Lord Jesus Christ is Himself the Living Divine Word.

The Living Divine Word performed holy living actions through His holy words and divine authority.

The Living Divine Word healed the sick.

The Living Divine Word raised the dead.

The Living Divine Word calmed the storms.

The Living Divine Word cast out demons and evil spirits.

The Living Divine Word taught humanity the manner of holy living.

The Living Divine Word taught virtue, holiness, righteousness, discipline, repentance, confession, prayer, love, forgiveness, mercy, peace, charity, Heaven, and the Kingdom of God.

The Living Divine Word revealed the path toward Divine Grace and eternal life.

The implementation of the holy words of the Blessed Holy Lord Jesus Christ leads the believer toward a life of holiness, while the believer seeks the guidance of the Holy Spirit in Divine Grace.

The Living Divine Word confronted sin, evil, Satan, and death.

Through the resurrection of Christ, the Christian faith proclaims the victory of divine life over death.

Therefore, the mystery of Saying 1 is understood in this theological interpretation as a call to discover, understand, receive, and implement the holy words of the Living Divine Word:

“Whoever finds the interpretation of these words will not taste death.”

The holy words are not merely words to be read.

They are words to be understood.

They are words to be lived.

They are words that lead toward life.

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94. Research Conclusion in One Sentence

The Living Divine Word, Jesus Christ, reveals through His holy words and holy actions the way from sin toward holiness, from darkness toward light, from separation toward

Divine Grace, and from death toward resurrection and eternal life; therefore, to find the interpretation of His words is to seek their divine meaning and allow that meaning to become a living reality.

Bibliography and Primary Sources

Primary Christian Scriptures

The Holy Bible. Gospel according to John, especially John 1:1–18; 3:16; 5; 6; 8; 10; 11:25–26; 14:6.

The Holy Bible. Gospel according to Matthew, especially Matthew 4; 5–7; 25:31–46; 28.

The Holy Bible. Gospel according to Mark, especially Mark 4–5 and 16.

The Holy Bible. Gospel according to Luke, especially Luke 8; 15; 18; 24.

The Holy Bible. Acts of the Apostles.

The Holy Bible. Paul's First Letter to the Corinthians, especially chapter 15.

The Holy Bible. Letter to the Romans.

The Holy Bible. Letter to the Galatians.

The Holy Bible. Letter to the Ephesians.

The Holy Bible. Book of Revelation.

Primary Non-Canonical Text

Gospel of Thomas. Saying 1 and related sayings concerning life, death, seeking, finding, and interpretation.

The surviving textual tradition includes the Coptic version preserved at Nag Hammadi and Greek fragments from Oxyrhynchus.

Selected Textual Witnesses and Translations

Lambdin, Thomas O. *The Gospel of Thomas: A Translation from the Coptic Text.*

Patterson, Stephen J., and Marvin Meyer. *The Gospel of Thomas: Scholars' Translation.*

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Recommended Scholarly Areas for Further Research

Future research may examine:

1. The Coptic term translated as “interpretation.”
2. The Greek Oxyrhynchus fragment of Saying 1.
3. The relationship between Thomas 1 and John 8:51–52.
4. The relationship between Thomas 1 and John 11:25–26.
5. The relationship between Thomas 1 and the Johannine Logos.
6. Thomas's understanding of “life” and “death.”
7. The meaning of “secret sayings.”
8. Thomas's relationship to the Synoptic Gospels.
9. Early Christian concepts of resurrection.
10. Early Christian concepts of the immortal soul.
11. Development of Christian doctrines concerning hell.
12. Satan and demonic powers in early Christianity.
13. Grace and sanctification in Christian theology.
14. The role of the Holy Spirit in Christian spiritual transformation.
15. The relationship between theological interpretation and ethical implementation.

Final Author's Declaration

This paper presents a **Christian theological interpretation developed under the title [Pawan Upadhyay Bible]**.

It does not claim that every theological proposition presented here is explicitly contained in *Gospel of Thomas*, Saying 1.

Rather, Saying 1 serves as the central interpretive starting point:

“Whoever finds the interpretation of these sayings will not taste death.”

The research develops this saying through dialogue with the canonical Christian Scriptures and the author's theological understanding of Jesus Christ as the **Living Divine Word**.

Its central purpose is to explore the possibility that the interpretation of Christ's words is not complete until those words become a living spiritual reality.

The Living Word is Christ.

The holy words reveal the way.

The interpretation reveals their meaning.

Implementation transforms the life.

Grace sustains the believer.

The Holy Spirit guides the believer.

Holiness prepares the believer.

Resurrection gives hope.

And the Living Word gives victory over death.

✝️ **“Whoever finds the interpretation of the words of the Living Divine Word will not taste death.”** ✝️

Separate Note: The Deep Meaning of the Holy Words of Jesus Christ

The holy words of the Blessed Holy Lord Jesus Christ contain **deep spiritual meanings**. Jesus frequently taught through **parables**, using ordinary events, people, objects, nature, and situations to communicate profound spiritual truths.

A parable may appear simple on the surface, yet its deeper meaning can reveal truths concerning **God, the Kingdom of God, repentance, faith, forgiveness, holiness, love, judgment, mercy, salvation, and eternal life**.

Therefore, hearing the words of Jesus is not necessarily the same as understanding their complete meaning.

The listener must seek.

The listener must contemplate.

The listener must pray for wisdom.

The listener must seek the spiritual interpretation.

This gives particular significance to the first saying of the *Gospel of Thomas*:

“Whoever finds the interpretation of these sayings will not taste death.”

The emphasis on **interpretation** can therefore be contemplated in relation to Jesus' use of parables. The outward story may be simple, while the inward spiritual meaning may be profound.

For example, a seed may represent something far greater than a seed. A shepherd may represent something far greater than a shepherd. A vineyard may communicate truths about God's Kingdom. A lost sheep may reveal the divine concern for the person who has gone astray.

The parable therefore contains both an **outer form** and an **inner meaning**.

The outer form can be heard by everyone.

The deeper meaning requires seeking, reflection, spiritual understanding, and openness to God's revelation.

The Parable and Spiritual Transformation

The purpose of discovering the deeper meaning is not merely to become intellectually knowledgeable.

The deeper meaning should transform the life of the person who discovers it.

Thus:

Hearing the parable → seeking its meaning → discovering its spiritual interpretation → understanding the teaching → implementing the teaching → spiritual transformation.

In this sense, the parables of Jesus are not merely stories.

They are **holy teachings of the Living Divine Word**.

They invite the listener to look beyond the visible story toward the invisible spiritual reality.

The Living Divine Word and the Hidden Meaning

Because Jesus Christ is understood in Christian theology as the **Living Divine Word**, His teachings can be approached with reverence and spiritual attentiveness.

The parables reveal divine truths through earthly images.

The visible points toward the invisible.

The earthly story points toward the heavenly reality.

The temporary points toward the eternal.

The ordinary points toward the divine.

Therefore, the person seeking the interpretation of Christ's words must seek not only the literal story but also the spiritual truth that Christ communicates through it.

Conclusion

The holy words of the Blessed Holy Lord Jesus Christ have profound spiritual depth.

His parables invite humanity to **seek, understand, repent, believe, and live according to the truth of God**.

The deeper interpretation of His words is therefore connected with the transformation of the soul.

The parable is heard by the ears, its meaning is sought by the mind, its truth is received by the heart, and its teaching is manifested through a holy life.

Thus, the deep meanings of the holy words of the Living Divine Word lead the seeker beyond the surface of the words toward the spiritual realities of **God, His Kingdom, holiness, Divine Grace, salvation, resurrection, and eternal life**.